

AUTHENTICATION CONCEPTS

What is the Authentication Service?

When you [create a game](#), you will need to [register players](#) or allow players to [sign in](#) the game before they can interact with features in other services that require a player account.

Once a player is registered or signed in, a session key will be returned for this player. Passing this session key into other services allows this player to interact with other Construct Game Services. **The session key is private to this player and should never be shared or exposed.**

All players have a unique **player ID** which is a [guid](#). Players also have a **player name** which can be displayed publicly. If a player signs in with a username and password it should be noted that the **username** is different to the **player name** and is only used to authenticate the sign in.

Registering Players

There are two ways to register players:

- Specific call to the [register player](#) end point
- [Signing in a player](#) with a supported [login provider](#)

If you register a player manually and **don't** provide a username and password, if the session key expires or is lost this player account will be unrecoverable. It is advised if possible to encourage the player to set a username/password, or [link to a login provider](#) at some point to ensure they can use this newly created account.

When a player [signs in](#) with a login provider, a new player will be registered if this player has not previously signed into your game. If the

player has previously signed in with this login provider, a new session key will be generated which ties them to their already established player ID.

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